Weeknight Recipes: Ten Dinners in Under 45 Minutes

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How to Use This Collection

Each recipe serves four unless noted, and lists active time (hands-on) and total time. Oven temperatures are given for conventional ovens; reduce by 20 C (25 F) for fan or convection ovens. Recipes marked (V) are vegetarian and (VG) are vegan. Allergen notes appear at the end of each recipe.

1. Lemon Garlic Chicken Traybake

Active time 15 minutes, total time 45 minutes.

Ingredients: 8 bone-in chicken thighs (about 1.2 kg), 600 g baby potatoes halved, 1 lemon cut into wedges, 6 garlic cloves lightly crushed, 3 tablespoons olive oil, 1 teaspoon dried oregano, 1 teaspoon salt, half a teaspoon black pepper, a handful of fresh parsley.

1. Heat the oven to 220 C (425 F).
2. Toss the potatoes, lemon wedges and garlic with 2 tablespoons of oil, half the salt and the oregano in a large roasting tray.
3. Rub the chicken with the remaining oil, salt and pepper and place skin side up on top of the potatoes.
4. Roast for 35 to 40 minutes, until the skin is golden and the chicken reaches 74 C (165 F) at the thickest point.
5. Squeeze the roasted lemon over everything and scatter with chopped parsley.

Allergens: none of the major allergens.

2. Chickpea and Spinach Curry (VG)

Active time 15 minutes, total time 30 minutes.

Ingredients: 2 tablespoons vegetable oil, 1 large onion finely chopped, 3 garlic cloves, a 3 cm piece of ginger grated, 2 tablespoons medium curry paste, 2 cans chickpeas (400 g each) drained, 1 can chopped tomatoes (400 g), 1 can coconut milk (400 ml), 200 g baby spinach, juice of half a lime, salt.

1. Fry the onion in the oil over medium heat for 8 minutes until soft.
2. Add the garlic, ginger and curry paste and cook for 1 minute.
3. Add the chickpeas, tomatoes and coconut milk. Simmer for 12 minutes.
4. Stir in the spinach until wilted, then add the lime juice and salt to taste. Serve with rice or flatbread.

Allergens: check the curry paste label; some contain mustard or celery.

3. Fifteen-Minute Garlic Noodles (V)

Active time 15 minutes, total time 15 minutes. Serves 2.

Ingredients: 250 g egg noodles, 3 tablespoons butter, 6 garlic cloves minced, 2 tablespoons soy sauce, 1 tablespoon oyster sauce or vegetarian mushroom sauce, 1 teaspoon brown sugar, 2 spring onions sliced, 30 g grated Parmesan.

1. Cook the noodles according to the packet. Reserve 60 ml of the cooking water.
2. Melt the butter over low heat and cook the garlic for 2 minutes without browning.
3. Stir in the soy sauce, oyster or mushroom sauce and sugar.
4. Toss in the noodles with a splash of cooking water, then the Parmesan and spring onions.

Allergens: gluten, egg, milk, soy (and shellfish if using oyster sauce).

4. Black Bean Tacos with Quick Pickled Onions (V)

Active time 20 minutes, total time 25 minutes.

Ingredients: 1 red onion thinly sliced, 120 ml cider vinegar, 1 teaspoon sugar, 1 teaspoon salt, 2 cans black beans (400 g each) drained, 1 teaspoon ground cumin, 1 teaspoon smoked paprika, 8 small corn tortillas, 1 avocado, 100 g feta crumbled, fresh coriander, 1 lime.

1. Put the onion in a jar with the vinegar, sugar, half the salt and 60 ml hot water. Leave for at least 15 minutes.
2. Warm the beans with the cumin, paprika, the rest of the salt and a splash of water, mashing about half of them.
3. Warm the tortillas in a dry pan for 30 seconds per side.
4. Fill each tortilla with beans, sliced avocado, feta, pickled onions and coriander. Serve with lime wedges.

Allergens: milk (feta). Leave out the feta for a vegan version.

5. Salmon with Miso Glaze and Greens

Active time 10 minutes, total time 20 minutes.

Ingredients: 4 salmon fillets (about 150 g each), 2 tablespoons white miso, 1 tablespoon honey, 1 tablespoon rice vinegar, 1 teaspoon sesame oil, 300 g green beans or broccolini, 1 teaspoon sesame seeds.

1. Heat the grill (broiler) to high. Mix the miso, honey, vinegar and sesame oil.
2. Place the salmon on a lined tray and spread the glaze over the top.
3. Grill for 7 to 9 minutes until the glaze is caramelized and the salmon flakes easily.
4. Meanwhile steam the greens for 4 minutes. Serve sprinkled with sesame seeds.

Allergens: fish, soy, sesame.

6. One-Pot Tomato and Basil Orzo (V)

Active time 10 minutes, total time 25 minutes.

Ingredients: 2 tablespoons olive oil, 1 onion, 2 garlic cloves, 300 g orzo, 1 can chopped tomatoes (400 g), 750 ml vegetable stock, 100 g mozzarella torn, a large handful of basil, salt and pepper.

1. Soften the onion in the oil for 5 minutes; add the garlic for 1 minute.
2. Add the orzo, tomatoes and stock. Simmer, stirring often, for 12 to 14 minutes until the orzo is tender and most of the liquid is absorbed.
3. Season, then top with mozzarella and basil and cover for 2 minutes so the cheese softens.

Allergens: gluten, milk, possibly celery (stock).

7. Turkey and Vegetable Stir-Fry

Active time 20 minutes, total time 20 minutes.

Ingredients: 500 g turkey mince, 1 tablespoon vegetable oil, 1 red pepper, 1 carrot cut into matchsticks, 200 g mushrooms, 2 tablespoons soy sauce, 1 tablespoon hoisin sauce, 1 teaspoon cornflour mixed with 2 tablespoons water, 2 spring onions, cooked rice to serve.

1. Brown the turkey in the oil over high heat for 5 minutes, breaking it up.
2. Add the vegetables and stir-fry for 4 minutes.
3. Add the soy, hoisin and cornflour mixture and cook for 1 minute until glossy.
4. Scatter with spring onions and serve over rice.

Allergens: soy, gluten (in most soy and hoisin sauces).

8. Red Lentil Soup (VG)

Active time 10 minutes, total time 35 minutes.

Ingredients: 2 tablespoons olive oil, 1 onion, 2 carrots, 2 garlic cloves, 2 teaspoons ground cumin, 250 g red lentils rinsed, 1.2 litres vegetable stock, 1 can chopped tomatoes (400 g), juice of 1 lemon.

1. Soften the onion and carrot in the oil for 8 minutes. Add the garlic and cumin for 1 minute.
2. Add the lentils, stock and tomatoes. Simmer for 20 minutes until the lentils collapse.
3. Blend until smooth, add the lemon juice and season. Keeps for 4 days in the fridge or 3 months frozen.

Allergens: possibly celery (stock).

9. Sheet-Pan Gnocchi with Sausage and Peppers

Active time 10 minutes, total time 30 minutes.

Ingredients: 500 g shelf-stable potato gnocchi (do not boil), 4 Italian sausages cut into chunks, 2 peppers in strips, 1 red onion in wedges, 2 tablespoons olive oil, 1 teaspoon fennel seeds, 30 g Parmesan.

1. Heat the oven to 220 C (425 F).
2. Toss everything except the Parmesan on a large baking tray in a single layer.
3. Roast for 20 to 25 minutes, turning once, until the gnocchi are crisp.
4. Grate over the Parmesan to serve.

Allergens: gluten, milk; check sausages for sulphites.

10. Peanut Noodle Salad (VG)

Active time 20 minutes, total time 20 minutes.

Ingredients: 200 g rice noodles, 3 tablespoons smooth peanut butter, 2 tablespoons soy sauce, 1 tablespoon maple syrup, juice of 1 lime, 1 teaspoon chilli flakes, 1 cucumber, 2 carrots, 1 red cabbage wedge finely shredded, a handful of mint and coriander, 40 g roasted peanuts.

1. Soak or cook the noodles as directed, then rinse under cold water.
2. Whisk the peanut butter, soy, maple syrup, lime and chilli with 3 tablespoons warm water.
3. Toss the noodles with the vegetables, herbs and dressing. Top with peanuts.

Allergens: peanuts, soy.

Quick Reference

Recipe	Total time	Diet	Main allergens
Lemon Garlic Chicken Traybake	45 min		None
Chickpea and Spinach Curry	30 min	VG	Check curry paste
Garlic Noodles	15 min	V	Gluten, egg, milk, soy
Black Bean Tacos	25 min	V	Milk
Miso Salmon	20 min		Fish, soy, sesame
Tomato and Basil Orzo	25 min	V	Gluten, milk
Turkey Stir-Fry	20 min		Soy, gluten
Red Lentil Soup	35 min	VG	Celery (stock)
Sheet-Pan Gnocchi	30 min		Gluten, milk
Peanut Noodle Salad	20 min	VG	Peanuts, soy